



Vulnerability Assessment Report

Lumi Education Pty Ltd · ABN 45 700 349 015 · 24 July 2026

FINAL · 2026-07-24

Document: ST4S evidence **EV11** (Vulnerability Assessment). Feeds **EV10** (interim, pending the independent external penetration test). **Version:** 1.0 · **Date:** 24 July 2026 **Assessment type:** Authorised, self-managed, source-code-assisted security assessment **Target:** Lumi Reading — Firebase/GCP application (`lumi-ninc-au`, `australia-southeast1`) **Prepared by:** Security Lead (Nic) with an AI orchestration (Opus 4.8 finders + Fable reviewer/verifier) **Classification:** Internal — no secrets, credentials, tokens, or personal information are reproduced in this report; findings reference code by file/location only. **Companions:** `SECURITY_ASSESSMENT_ORCHESTRATION_PLAN.md` (method) · `FINDINGS_REGISTER.md` (live register) · `ASSESSMENT_STATUS.md` (status board) · `PENTEST_DRYRUN_FINDINGS_2026-07-20.md` (prior in-house pass, deduped).

1. Executive summary

A structured, source-code-assisted assessment of the Lumi Reading platform was conducted 23–24 July 2026, covering the Firestore/Storage security rules, Cloud Functions, the `packages/server-ops` privileged core, both Next.js portals, the Flutter application, and the CI/CD posture. The assessment used a multi-agent orchestration (parallel Opus 4.8 analysts, each finding verified by a Fable reviewer) with all dynamic testing confined to the Firebase Emulator Suite on synthetic data; production was treated as read-only.

Overall posture is strong. Multi-tenant isolation is structurally sound (every authorization decision derives from a server-written membership document, never a client claim), both portals close the historically-known cookie-forgery / IDOR / self-provisioning classes, and Cloud Functions callables are consistently well-authorised.

Nine application/rules findings were identified (1 High-framed, several Medium, the rest Low/Info), plus a clean SAST baseline (1 low item) and a dependency (SCA) baseline. The single most material finding — **F-01**, a new create-vs-update rules asymmetry allowing a forged entitlement — was not present in the prior in-house pass; it was confirmed dynamically in the emulator and fixed.

Remediation is complete for every fixable finding. As of this report, F-01, F-02, F-03, A2/F-09, SAST-01, F-07 and F-04 are all fixed, regression-tested, merged, and **deployed to production**. Two findings are accepted-by-design (F-06, F-08), and one (F-05, App Check enforcement) is a launch-gated control tracked separately. Each rules fix is protected by a new emulator regression test wired into CI.

2. Scope

In scope (Lumi's own code and configuration):

- `firestore.rules`, `storage.rules` and their test suites.

- Cloud Functions (`functions/src/**`) — ~35 callables, 1 IAM-locked HTTP function, ~20 scheduled, ~27 event-triggered.
- `packages/server-ops/**` — the privileged operation modules.
- School portal (`school-admin-web/`) and super-admin portal (`admin/`) — Next.js SSR API routes, session/auth.
- Flutter application (`lib/**`) — MASVS/MASTG static review.
- CI/CD security tooling.

Out of scope (per the vendor register): Google/Firebase platform internals, SendGrid/Twilio, Apple/Google stores, Open Library / Google Books services — the assessment tests Lumi's *configuration and use* of these, never the vendors' own infrastructure.

Explicitly excluded: DoS/load/volumetric testing, password spraying, credential stuffing, phishing/social engineering, destructive exploits, data exfiltration, stealth/evasion, unbounded fuzzing, and any action against real child data or production tenants.

3. Methodology

- **Orchestration:** parallel Opus 4.8 analysts each mapped one surface (backend authz, rules, portals, vendor boundary, environment); a Fable reviewer de-duplicated against the closed known-issues list, reconciled cross-analyst conflicts, and adversarially verified every High/Critical against source before it was accepted.
- **Standards:** OWASP ASVS / WSTG, OWASP Top 10 (2025) + SANS CWE Top 25, MASVS/MASTG (mobile).
- **Dynamic testing:** Firebase Emulator Suite (`demo-lumi-*` throwaway projects), **synthetic data only**. Each confirmed finding was reproduced as a client-SDK proof-of-concept, then converted into a permanent regression test (`functions/test/security_poc.rules.test.js`).
- **Static tooling:** `semgrep` (SAST), `npm/pnpm audit` + `osv-scanner` config (SCA), `gitleaks` (secrets).
- **Production:** read-only. No exploitation. TLS/config scanning (S1/S3/S5) is deferred pending an explicit written scope exception.

4. Findings summary

Severity is Fable-reconciled (control-bypass framing vs. current blast radius). Status is as of 24 Jul 2026.

ID	Finding	Severity	ST4S	Status
F-01	Student <code>create</code> rule omitted the server-owned-field denylist → forgeable live <code>access</code> entitlement (self-provisionable)	High / Med	S4, A13	✅ Fixed + deployed
F-02	School <code>create</code> rule omitted the commercial-fields guard (subscription/access/accessMode/isDemo)	Medium	S4	✅ Fixed + deployed
F-03	Class <code>update</code> allowed a teacher to reassign ownership (teacherId/teacherIds)	Med-Low	S4	✅ Fixed + deployed
F-04	<code>server-ops</code> destructive ops had no in-module authz (single-layer)	Med (def-in-depth)	A5, S4, A13	✅ Fixed + deployed

ID	Finding	Severity	ST4S	Status
F-05	App Check enforcement OFF on all callables	Low-Med	A13, S7	🚫 Launch-gated (staged rollout)
F-06	Storage cover first-claim open to any authenticated user	Low	S4, PF51	📄 Accept-as-designed
F-07	<code>books/lookup</code> ISBN param injection + external-API cost amplification, no rate limit	Low	Q5	✅ Fixed + deployed
F-08	Portal CSRF relies on <code>SameSite=Lax</code> alone	Low	A13	📄 Accept-as-designed
F-09	Portal <code>createUser</code> password minimum 6 chars (part of A2)	Low	A2	✅ Fixed + deployed
SAST-01	Super-admin MFA-crypto GCM decrypt without pinned <code>authTagLength</code>	Low	Q5, EV13	✅ Fixed + deployed
SCA-01	9 transitive advisories (8 mod, 1 high) under <code>firebase-admin</code>	High/Mod	T2/T3/AP1	🚫 Tracked (no clean upstream fix)
A2	Passwords enforced at 6–8 chars (not the claimed 14+/complexity)	—	A2	✅ Fixed + deployed
M-01... M-08	Mobile AP2 items (Hive-at-rest, audio/widget at-rest, no pinning, etc.)	Low-Med	AP2	Mostly known/accepted (see §5.4)

5. Detailed findings

5.1 F-01 — Student-create entitlement forgery (S4/A13) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

Description. The student `create` rule (`firestore.rules`) required only role + `schoolId` match, omitting the server-owned-field denylist (`access`, `parentIds`, `autoAward`, `pendingDeletion`, `feelingsByDay`, `latestParentComment`) that the `update` rule enforced. The server trigger `grantAccessOnStudentCreate` bails when `access` is pre-seeded, so nothing reconciled a forged value. **Impact.** A schoolAdmin/teacher — including a self-provisioned admin (client school-create → admin bootstrap → student create) — could mint a student that is entitlement-live from creation, bypassing `studentAccessLive`, the rules' single licensing-enforcement point. A licensing/authorization-control bypass; blast radius currently limited (within-tenant; AI eval dark) but latent for any access-gated paid feature. **Not present in the prior in-house pass** (which tested `update` but not `create`). **Remediation.** One shared field list now guards create and update; the trigger is unchanged. **Verification:** emulator PoC confirmed the pre-fix exploit and now confirms denial; full rules suite 172/172 green. **Fix commit** `0d31809`, **deployed** `firestore:rules`.

5.2 F-02 — School-create commercial-field seeding (S4) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

School `create` omitted the guard the `update` path enforced, letting a creator self-seed `subscription` / `access` / `accessMode` / `isDemo`. Fixed with a `schoolCommercialFieldsAbsentOnCreate()` guard; emulator regression test added. Deployed.

5.3 F-03 — Class-update ownership reassignment (S4) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

Class `update` authorised a teacher-of-class with no field restriction, allowing reassignment of `teacherId` / `teacherIds` (hand the class to an attacker uid, or self-removal). Fixed by a `classOwnershipUnchanged()` guard on the teacher branch (schoolAdmins retain reassignment). Emulator regression test added. Deployed.

5.4 F-04 — server-ops single-layer authorization (A5/S4/A13) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

The `packages/server-ops` destructive operations (offboard a school, delete parent accounts, grant dev-access, disable staff auth) carried no internal authorization — the only gate was the calling super-admin portal route's `verifySession()`. Not exploitable at assessment time (all routes gate), but single-layer. **Remediation:** a fail-closed `assertSuperAdmin(db, actor.uid)` — mirroring `admin/isSuperAdminViaFirestore` and `functions/isSuperAdmin` (`/superAdmins/{uid}` doc + `SUPER_ADMIN_UIDS` bootstrap env) — added to the five destructive super-admin-only ops. No behaviour change for legitimate callers. Unit test `authority.parity.test.ts`. **PR #561, auto-deployed via `admin-deploy`.**

5.5 F-05 — App Check enforcement OFF (A13/S7) — LAUNCH-GATED

Firebase App Check is unenforced on all callables (client attestation flags default off), enabling scripted abuse of low-auth callables (SMS toll-fraud, code enumeration, marketing spam). Enabling now would lock out clients because valid store-signed App Attest / Play Integrity evidence requires the app to be published. Tracked in `REMAINING_HARDENING_RUNBOOK.md` §6 as a staged rollout. **Not a code defect.**

5.6 F-06 — Storage cover first-claim (S4/PF51) — ACCEPT-AS-DESIGNED

Any authenticated non-demo user may first-claim an unclaimed community-book cover. Documented as an intended tradeoff (`storage.rules.test.js:373`): Storage rules cannot read Firestore for role, accounts are invite-only, covers are non-personal, and the enforced protections (uploaderUid = caller; no overwrite of another user's cover) stand. Optional uplift: callable-mediated upload with a server-side role check.

5.7 F-07 — books/lookup injection + amplification (Q5) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

The `books/lookup` route interpolated a caller-supplied ISBN into external Google Books / Open Library URLs after stripping only separators, and had no rate limit (query-parameter injection + external-API cost amplification for any authenticated staff member). **Remediation:** strict ISBN-10/13 validation (route zod regex + `isValidIsbn` guard) so only clean digits reach the external URLs, plus a 60/min per-user rate limit via the existing `consumeRateLimit`. Portal typecheck clean. Deployed (school portal).

5.8 F-08 — CSRF via SameSite=Lax (A13) — ACCEPT-AS-DESIGNED

State-changing portal routes rely on `SameSite=Lax` cookies (a same-origin `Origin` guard exists only on demo-allocation + auth-session routes). Cross-site exploitation is infeasible given Lax + Firebase PSL-separated default domains; residual risk is a same-registrable-domain sibling on custom domains. Recommendation: extend the existing `assertSameOrigin` guard to all mutation routes when convenient.

5.9 F-09 / A2 — Password strength (A2) — FIXED + DEPLOYED

Passwords were enforced at 6–8 characters depending on surface (portal `createUser` min-6; app signup 8 + upper/lower/digit; temp passwords 12 chars, no symbol) — the ST4S submission claimed 14+/complexity. **Remediation:** a shared 14+/upper-lower-digit-symbol validator across the portal (API + modal) and the three app signup screens; all three temp-password generators produce 16-char/symbol passwords compliant *by construction* (the Admin-SDK paths bypass any policy); and the Firebase Console password policy was set to

Require / min 14 / all four classes (evidence captured). A2 is now true across every surface. Deployed (portal + `processStaffOnboardingEmail`); app-side validators ship with the next app release; console policy is the server-side gate for client-SDK signups + hosted resets.

5.10 Mobile (AP2 / MASVS) findings

Static MASVS/MASTG review. Good posture: the one PII-bearing signup box is AES-256 encrypted with a Keychain/Keystore key; deep-link validation is strict (scheme/host/path allowlist, no query-param forwarding); no WebView; Analytics/Crashlytics off until adult opt-in; `allowBackup=false` + data-extraction rules exclude every domain from cloud-backup/device-transfer.

- **M-01** (Med, known): Hive offline caches (students/reading_logs/pending_sync) unencrypted at rest — local-access-only (rooted/forensic).
- **M-02** (Low-Med, new): comprehension audio written unencrypted pre-sync, then deleted.
- **M-03** (Low, new): iOS widget App-Group stores child `firstName` + streak as plaintext JSON.
- **M-04**: App Check backend enforcement off (= F-05).
- **M-05–M-08** (Low/Info): no cert pinning (acceptable with Firebase), no root/anti-tamper, Firebase API keys in bundle (not a secret), `debugPrint` in release (reviewed clean). An external MASTG tester should perform rooted-device at-rest inspection, backup-vector extraction, deep-link fuzzing, App Check replay, MITM-with-user-CA, and runtime/Frida checks.

6. Automated scanning baselines

- **SCA-01 (dependencies)**: `npm audit` on `functions` reports 9 transitive advisories (8 moderate, 1 high) — all under `firebase-admin` (`@google-cloud/firestore` → `google-gax`; `@google-cloud/storage` → `teeny-request` → `uuid`). No clean upstream fix (`--force` breaks). Tracked; Dependabot + osv-scanner now watch it.
- **SAST**: `semgrep` (typescript/javascript/secrets/owasp-top-ten over functions/portals/server-ops) — **one** finding total (SAST-01, low, now fixed), no secrets flagged. A clean baseline consistent with the gitleaks-clean history.
- **Secrets**: `gitleaks` full-history — clean.
- **New CI controls (AP1/T1/T2/EV11)**: Dependabot (npm/pub/actions), osv-scanner and semgrep workflows (monthly + on-demand; per-PR wiring pending ref verification), and this findings register.

7. Positive assurance

- **Multi-tenant isolation (S4)**: dynamically proven — a school-A teacher cannot read school-B data directly nor via an unconstrained collection-group sweep (`security_poc.rules.test.js`, S4 test). No cross-tenant path was found anywhere.
- **Deny-by-default (A13)**: strong — implicit deny + explicit `allow read, write: if false` on ~20 server-only collections; no recursive wildcard.
- **Portal session/auth**: the historical cookie-forgery, reset-password IDOR, teacher self-provisioning and claims-clobber classes are all closed with visible fixes; sessions are revocation-aware and fail closed.

8. Residual & accepted risks / recommendations

Item	Disposition	Recommendation
F-05 App Check	Launch-gated	Enable (Require) once the app ships store-signed attestation
F-06 cover first-claim	Accepted	Optional: callable-mediated upload with role check
F-08 CSRF (SameSite)	Accepted	Extend <code>assertSameOrigin</code> to all mutation routes
SCA-01 firebase-admin transitives	Tracked	Bump <code>firebase-admin</code> when a patched release lands
M-01/M-02/M-03 at-rest	Known/new	Optional: encrypt Hive boxes + the audio staging dir with a Keychain/Keystore key
Wave 3 (TLS/config prod scan)	Not performed	Run under an explicit read-only scope exception (feeds S1/S3/S5)
External penetration test	Outstanding	Independent CREST/OSCP test for EV10 (scoping pack ready)

9. ST4S mapping

Directly evidenced or advanced by this assessment: **S4, A13, A5** (tenant isolation, deny-by-default, privileged-access — validated + hardened, F-01–F-04); **A2** (passwords — now true); **Q5** (security testing performed to a framework); **AP1/T1/T2** (scanning cadence + Dependabot); **AP2** (mobile MASTG static review); **EV11** (this report); **EV10** (interim — external test outstanding). SAST-01 also feeds **EV13** (secure SDLC).

10. Remediation status

All fixable findings are remediated and deployed to production as of 24 Jul 2026: F-01, F-02, F-03 (`firestore:rules`), A2/F-09 (portal + functions + console policy), SAST-01 + F-04 (super-admin portal, `admin-deploy`), F-07 (school portal). Every rules fix carries an emulator regression test wired into CI. Remaining items are launch-gated (F-05), accepted-by-design (F-06, F-08), upstream-tracked (SCA-01), or require the outstanding independent external penetration test (EV10) and a scoped production TLS scan (Wave 3).

— End of report —